

To: **StarTrack Senior Management**

Re: **Follow-Up Regarding API Contractors' Concerns and Supporting Information**

We, the StarTrack API Drivers and Contractors, are formally following up on the concerns previously submitted to management. We are writing to ensure these matters are escalated to senior management and addressed as a priority. The drivers have remained patient and professional throughout this process and continue to place their trust in StarTrack to resolve these longstanding issues fairly.

To support our submission, we have attached payslips from comparable transport companies, together with information outlining the operating expenses incurred by owner-drivers. We believe these documents clearly demonstrate the urgent need for a review of current arrangements.

1. API Hours and Income Stability

The ongoing and unpredictable fluctuation in API hours has created significant financial uncertainty for contractors. Drivers are unable to plan their finances, meet vehicle repayments, or manage business expenses when hours change without notice or adequate explanation. We formally request a more stable and consistent allocation of hours to provide contractors with greater income security and the ability to sustain their operations.

2. Review of Hourly Rates

The current hourly rate paid to API contractors is insufficient and must be urgently reviewed. Owner-drivers bear the full cost of running their businesses, including:

- Fuel and vehicle running costs
- Vehicle maintenance and repairs
- Insurance and registration
- WorkCover contributions
- Superannuation obligations
- Other general business operating expenses

These costs have continued to rise significantly. The current rate does not reflect this reality and must be increased to a level that allows contractors to operate sustainably and fairly.

3. Professional Treatment of Drivers

Drivers must be treated with fairness, dignity, and respect at all times. We are deeply concerned about incidents in which drivers have been told — either directly or indirectly — that they must accept reduced hours or roster changes, or otherwise leave their engagement. This type of communication is threatening, coercive, and completely unacceptable in a professional working environment.

4. Formal Complaint — Management Conduct

• Threatening and Coercive Behaviour

On multiple occasions, Jason Booth has directly told drivers that they must either accept the hours offered — no matter how reduced — or leave their engagement entirely. This is not a reasonable or professional way to manage contractors. It is a threat, and it amounts to coercion. Drivers should never be placed in a position where they are forced to choose between accepting unacceptable work conditions or losing their livelihood.

- **Culture of Fear and Intimidation**

The pattern of behaviour displayed by Jason Booth has created a culture of fear among drivers. Many drivers feel unable to raise legitimate concerns because they fear retaliation — including further reduction of their hours or removal from the roster entirely. This is not a healthy or lawful working environment. It discourages open communication, suppresses legitimate grievances, and has caused significant distress and anxiety among the contractor group.

- **Disrespectful Communication**

Drivers have consistently reported being spoken to in a dismissive, disrespectful, and unprofessional manner by Jason Booth. Contractors are skilled professionals who provide an essential service. They deserve to be communicated with respectfully and treated as valued business partners — not as disposable labour. The current treatment is deeply demoralising and has had a serious negative impact on morale, wellbeing, and trust.

- **Lack of Transparency and Written Communication**

Changes to hours, rates, and work arrangements have been communicated verbally and without adequate notice or explanation. When drivers have sought clarification — by phone or email — Jason Booth has failed to respond in a timely or satisfactory manner. This lack of transparency is unacceptable and has left drivers without the information they need to manage their businesses.

- **Impact on Drivers**

The conduct described above has had a real and serious impact on drivers. Financially, reduced and unstable hours have made it extremely difficult for contractors to cover their operating costs, meet vehicle repayments, and support their families. Emotionally, the intimidation and disrespect experienced at the hands of management has caused genuine stress, anxiety, and a loss of trust in StarTrack as an organisation.

We formally request that senior management urgently investigate Jason Booth's conduct, take appropriate corrective action where necessary, and ensure that all future communication with drivers is professional, respectful, and provided in writing. We also request a formal written assurance that no driver will face threats, intimidation, or any form of retaliation for raising genuine workplace concerns or exercising their lawful rights as contractors.

5. Written Contractor Agreements

All contractors must be provided with a formal written agreement clearly outlining the agreed hourly rate, expected or minimum hours, payment terms, and all other key conditions of engagement. The absence of clear written agreements has allowed for inconsistency, confusion, and unfair treatment. Written agreements protect both parties and provide a clear framework for the contractor relationship.

6. Written Communication for All Operational Matters

To ensure full transparency and avoid misunderstandings, all important communication regarding hours, rates, work allocation, and operational changes must be provided to drivers in writing and with reasonable advance notice. Verbal instructions or informal phone calls are not an adequate substitute for formal written communication, particularly when changes affect contractors' income and working arrangements.

Our Position

As a collective group, we are seeking a timely resolution. These issues have been affecting drivers for a considerable period and deserve urgent attention. We remain committed to working cooperatively with StarTrack and management to achieve a fair outcome that supports both the business and its contractors.

We respectfully request a written response outlining the proposed next steps and timeframe for addressing these concerns.

Kind regards,

All API Drivers and Contractors

This letter is submitted collectively by StarTrack API Drivers and Contractors in good faith with the intention of reaching a fair, lawful, and respectful resolution for all parties.

OWNER-DRIVER OPERATING EXPENSES & TAKE-HOME PAY

This document outlines the estimated operating expenses incurred by an owner-driver contractor and the actual take-home pay after GST and expenses are deducted. All costs are borne entirely by the driver. This breakdown demonstrates why the current hourly rate is insufficient.

Monthly Operating Expenses Breakdown

Expense Item	Est. Monthly Cost (AUD)
Servicing & Repairs	\$300
Tyres	\$80
Registration	\$80
Public Liability + Marine + Van Insurance	\$350
WorkCover / Workers Compensation	\$300
Roadside Assistance	\$25
Accounting, Bookkeeping & Company Costs	\$150
Vehicle Cleaning & Miscellaneous (\$1,200 ÷ 12)	\$100
Vehicle Finance (if financed)	\$1,200
Tax (\$6,000 ÷ 12)	\$500
TOTAL MONTHLY	\$3,165

Yearly Total	\$37,980 / year	Monthly Total	\$3,165 / month	Weekly Total	\$730 / week
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Take-Home Pay Analysis — After GST & Weekly Expenses

The table below shows the actual take-home pay. StarTrack pays \$34/hr + 10% GST separately. GST belongs to the ATO — not the driver. After deducting GST and weekly operating expenses of \$730 (including \$300 vehicle finance), the real take-home is as follows:

Scenario	Hours /Week	Gross Pay (incl. GST)	GST (-10%)	After GST & Expenses	Effective Hourly Rate
10 hrs/day x 6 days	60	\$2,244.00	-\$204.00	\$1,310.00	\$21.83/hr
8 hrs/day x 6 days	48	\$1,795.20	-\$163.20	\$902.00	\$18.79/hr
6.5 hrs/day x 6 days	39	\$1,458.60	-\$132.60	\$596.00	\$15.28/hr

When working only 39 hours per week (6.5 hrs/day), StarTrack pays \$1,458.60 (incl. GST). After returning \$132.60 GST to the ATO and covering weekly expenses of \$730, a driver takes home just \$596.00 per week — an effective hourly rate of \$15.28/hr. This is not a financially sustainable or fair income for a skilled owner-driver. An immediate review and increase of the hourly rate is essential.

This document has been prepared by StarTrack API Drivers and Contractors to support their formal grievance submission. All figures are estimated based on actual operating costs.